Contact Center: WhatsApp Integration

This article describes how to configure the Contact Center integration with WhatsApp using MessageBird (Bird). It is part of the Contact Center third-party integrations documentation.

WhatsApp Integration: Introduction

WhatsApp is one of the world's most widely used messaging applications, allowing people and businesses to communicate through text messages, images, videos, voice messages, and file sharing. Businesses commonly use WhatsApp to provide customer support through real-time messaging, allowing customers to contact support teams and have their WhatsApp interactions routed to agents, similar to SMS or chat.

Important: In August 2024, MessageBird rebranded to Bird and discontinued the Connectivity platform for new customers. Existing Connectivity integrations continue to operate with support. New customers must use the Bird Engagement platform.

- **Existing clients:** Your existing Connectivity integrations continue to function and are supported by Bird.
- **New clients:** Use the Bird Engagement platform via our system.

WhatsApp messaging is supported through integrations with MessageBird/Bird.

Important: The current version supports plain text WhatsApp messages only.

Contact Center administrators need an active MessageBird or Bird account to configure the integration in the Admin Portal. After setup, agents can send and receive messages with customers using the associated WhatsApp number.

WhatsApp uses the existing SMS and Messaging service framework (including Twilio features). Key operational requirements:

- Administrators must create chat queues and assign agents.
- After configuration, the WhatsApp number appears with other SMS/Messaging numbers and can be routed to a selected chat queue.
- Administrators can configure WhatsApp messaging settings similar to other SMS providers:
  - Send a reply when a message is received
  - Send a reply when the queue is closed
  - Send a reply when the queue is unattended
  - Optionally receive new messages when the queue is closed or unattended

Use the links below to set up and use the integrations.

- **MessageBird Integration**
  - MessageBird Prerequisite Conditions
  - Setting up a MessageBird Account and WhatsApp Channel
  - Setting up the MessageBird Integration Within the Contact Center Admin Portal
- **Bird Integration**
  - Setting up a Bird Account and WhatsApp Channel
  - Configuring Bird Prerequisite Security Settings
  - Setting up the Bird integration with the Contact Center Admin Portal
- **After the Integrations**
  - Configuring a WhatsApp Number in the Contact Center Admin Portal
  - Using WhatsApp with Contact Center
  - FAQs and List of Known Restrictions

▼ WhatsApp: Configuring a WhatsApp Number in the Contact Center Admin Portal

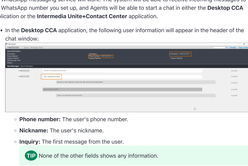
WhatsApp is part of the SMS and Messaging service and uses the same core functionality. This means:

- To use WhatsApp, the Contact Center administrator must create a chat queue and assign agents.
- After integration, the WhatsApp number appears with other SMS and Messaging numbers and can be routed to a selected chat queue.
- Contact Center administrators can configure WhatsApp messaging settings similarly to other SMS providers:
  - Send a reply when a message is received
  - Send a reply when the queue is closed
  - Send a reply when the queue is unattended
  - Optionally receive new messages when the queue is closed or unattended

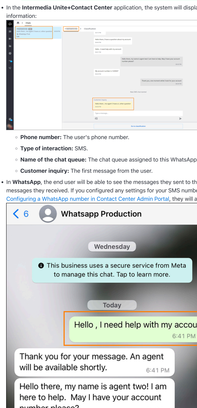
Configure WhatsApp messages

1. Log on to **Contact Center Admin Portal**.
2. Go to *Configure* > *General* > *Queues*. Click **Manage SMS and Messaging**.

3. On the page that opens, find the WhatsApp number you want to configure and click **Edit**.



4. In the **Edit SMS** dialog, enter the following information:

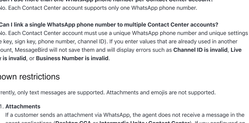


   a. **(Non-editable) SMS and Messaging:** The WhatsApp number linked to this chat queue.
   b. **(Non-editable) Channel:** The channel type.
   c. **Routing Action:** Choose **Send to Chat Queue** to link the WhatsApp number to a chat queue.
      Important: Do not select **Use for Dynotes** for any WhatsApp number. Outbound notifications are not supported by WhatsApp and using this option may cause the account to be flagged or disabled.
   d. **Queue:** The name of the queue linked to the WhatsApp number.
   e. **Description:** The purpose of the queue.
   f. Select any applicable options to control responses:
      i. **Accept SMS and messaging even if queue is closed or unattended:** Accept WhatsApp messages when the queue is closed or unattended.
      ii. **Reply when message is received:** Message sent when a WhatsApp message is received.
      iii. **Reply when queue is closed:** Message sent when the queue is closed.
      iv. **Reply when queue is unattended:** Message sent when the queue is unattended.
5. Click **OK** to save.

▼ WhatsApp: Using WhatsApp with Contact Center

Once you have finished configuring MessageBird and integrating it with Contact Center Admin Portal, the WhatsApp messaging service will work. The system will be able to receive incoming messages to the WhatsApp number you set up, and Agents will be able to start a chat in either the **Desktop CCA** application or the **Intermedia Unite+Contact Center** application.

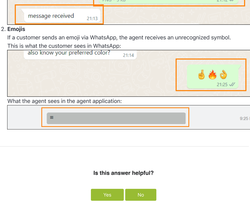
- In the **Desktop CCA** application, the following user information will appear in the header of the chat window:



  - **Phone number:** The user's phone number.
  - **Nickname:** The user's nickname.
  - **Inquiry:** The first message from the user.

> **TIP** None of the other fields shows any information.

- In the **Intermedia Unite+Contact Center** application, the system will display the following information:



  - **Phone number:** The user's phone number.
  - **Type of interaction:** SMS.
  - **Name of the chat queue:** The chat queue assigned to this WhatsApp number.
  - **Customer inquiry:** The first message from the user.
- In **WhatsApp**, the end user will be able to see the messages they sent to the Agent and the messages they received. If you configured any settings for your SMS number as explained in Configuring a WhatsApp number in Contact Center Admin Portal, they will appear accordingly.

▼ WhatsApp: FAQ and List of Known Restrictions

Q: Can I use more than one WhatsApp phone number per Contact Center account?
A: No. Each Contact Center account supports only one WhatsApp phone number.

Q: Can I link a single WhatsApp phone number to multiple Contact Center accounts?
A: No. Each Contact Center account must use a unique WhatsApp phone number and unique settings (live key, sign key, phone number, channel ID). If you enter values that are already used in another account, MessageBird will not save them and will display errors such as **Channel ID is invalid**, **Live Key is invalid**, or **Business Number is invalid**.

Known restrictions

Currently, only text messages are supported. Attachments and emojis are not supported.

1. **Attachments**
   If a customer sends an attachment via WhatsApp, the agent does not receive a message in the agent applications (**Desktop CCA** or **Intermedia Unite+Contact Center**). If you configured an automatic acknowledgment (see Configuring a WhatsApp number in Contact Center Admin Portal), the customer will still receive that acknowledgment, which can be confusing.

2. **Emojis**
   If a customer sends an emoji via WhatsApp, the agent receives an unrecognized symbol.
   This is what the customer sees in WhatsApp:

   What the agent sees in the agent application:

Is this answer helpful?

Yes | No

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Article Information

Article ID: 32631
Last updated on: 05/18/2026 05:48 PM
Product: Contact Center

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